

Cybersecurity Daily Newsletter

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Top 5 Highlights

- D-Link warns of critical vulnerabilities in legacy DIR-822A routers with public exploit code
- Ransomware group PAYLOAD weaponizes Microsoft Active Directory for disruption
- ICYMI: August 2026 @AWS Security
- SideCopy threat actor targets Indian academic institutions with new attack methods
- Worker stress increases due to AI-driven security threats

Threat Intelligence (10)

01. New RemControl Android banking malware targets users in Europe and Canada

A new Android malware-as-a-service (MaaS) platform called RemControl is targeting users through malvertising campaigns that impersonate the TVTap IPTV application. [...]

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/new-remcontrol-android-banking-malware-targets-users-in-europe-and-canada/>

02. GitLab Email Addresses Can Be Weaponized for Supply Chain Attacks

Incoming email addresses automatically assigned to each user on the platform contain highly privileged access tokens that attackers can use.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Audit build pipelines, rotate CI/CD secrets, enforce package integrity controls, and review developer workstation hardening.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/application-security/gitlab-email-addresses-supply-chain-attacks>

03. Attackers Use Malicious Terraform Providers to Deliver Go Malware via HashiCorp Registry

Cybersecurity researchers have disclosed Go-based malware distributed via two Go Modules and two Terraform providers, marking the first time threat actors are using the centralized repository hosted by HashiCorp as a distribution vector for malicious payloads. According to Aikido, the list of Terraform providers and Go modules is below - [gocommunity-io/dock...](https://github.com/gocommunity-io/dock)

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Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/attackers-use-malicious-terraform.html>

04. Macfinger ClickFix campaign, (Tue, Sep 22nd)

Introduction

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://isc.sans.edu/diary/rss/33360>

05. Attackers Manipulate AI Chatbots in Mass Disinformation, Phishing Campaign

Threat actors are poisoning ChatGPT, Gemini, and Google AI Overview answers by seeding the Web with malicious links and data and then optimizing the content.

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.darkreading.com/threat-intelligence/attackers-manipulate-ai-chatbots-mass-disinformation-phishing-campaign>

06. Supporting ASD's multi-factor authentication campaign: Why MFA matters more than ever

The Australian Signals Directorate (ASD) has this month issued a clear call to action through its Multi-factor authentication: Switch it on campaign, urging businesses, organisations, and individuals to enable multi-factor authentication (MFA) across their online accounts. At AWS, we strongly support this message. As threat actors continue to target credent...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/supporting-asds-multi-factor-authentication-campaign-why-mfa-matters-more-than-ever/>

07. This Windows Malware is Built to Let Up to Four AI Models Vote on Its Next Move

A Windows malware called CLOSEDQUORUM is built to take orders from a vote of up to four AI models instead of an attacker's server, Cisco Talos said on September 22. The models can choose to steal Windows credentials, saved browser passwords, and crypto wallet data. Talos has not seen this setup work from start to finish, and the public version of the malwar...

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Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/windows-malware-is-built-to-let-up-to.html>

08. Cofense measures employee readiness against real-world phishing threats

Cofense has announced an expansion of its AI-driven Phishing Defense Platform through Cofense Command Center, its orchestration layer for measurement and reporting. The new Competency Dashboard measures how employees recognize, report and respond to phishing threats, giving security teams evidence of program effectiveness rather than training completion. Th...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/23/cofense-command-center/>

09. Windows Botnet x47.c Offers AI API Draining, 18 Attack Methods

Qrator found a Windows botnet advertised with AI API draining, credential theft and SOCKS5 proxying

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Update detections and threat hunts using reported TTPs/IOCs, review email/web controls, and harden high-risk internet-facing services.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/x47c-botnet-ai-api-draining-18/>

10. DarkMe RAT trades zero-days for plain phishing emails

DarkMe, a remote access trojan and info-stealer that has previously been associated with a threat group that targeted financial market traders and cryptocurrency users, has been spotted again. This time around, its distribution has been simplified: instead of leveraging zero-day exploits, attackers are betting on a simple email to convince targets to run it...

Why it matters: Threat-actor tradecraft and active campaigns help defenders anticipate techniques likely to be used against their environment.

Recommendation: Tighten email authentication and filtering, run targeted user awareness, and monitor for lookalike domains and suspicious inbox rules.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/23/darkme-rat-phishing-email-hits-corporate-targets/>

Latest Vulnerabilities (10)

01. D-Link warns of critical vulnerabilities in legacy DIR-822A routers with public exploit code

The first vulnerability, CVE-2026-86296, is a stack-based buffer overflow in the DHCP server component.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/d-link-warns-of-critical-vulnerabilities-in-legacy-dir-822a-routers-with-public-exploit-code>

02. ICYMI: August 2026 @AWS Security

Read all about the latest AWS security features, compliance updates, and hands-on resources in our monthly digest posts. You'll find expert blog posts, new service capabilities, code samples, and workshops. AWS Security Blog posts August brought 20

AWS Security Blog posts organized across seven categories. Identity and access management led the month with f...

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Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://aws.amazon.com/blogs/security/icymi-august-2026-aws-security/>

03. SideCopy threat actor targets Indian academic institutions with new attack methods

SideCopy, an advanced persistent threat group originating from Pakistan and active since at least 2019, has historically targeted Indian defense forces and government officials.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/sidecopy-threat-actor-targets-indian-academic-institutions-with-new-attack-methods>

04. Worker stress increases due to AI-driven security threats

A recent report by Object First indicates that 91% of workers feel uncomfortably stressed by IT security risks, a seven percentage-point increase from last year.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/worker-stress-increases-due-to-ai-driven-security-threats>

05. ZTE SmartLife platform vulnerabilities allow account takeover

Security researcher Mina Nageh Salama disclosed four critical vulnerabilities in the SmartLife platform, with the most severe, CVE-2026-86553, rated 8.8.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/zte-smartlife-platform-vulnerabilities-allow-account-takeover>

06. F5 fixes actively exploited zero-day flaw in BIG-IP APM

Technology company F5 fixed a critical remote code execution vulnerability in its BIG-IP Access Policy Manager (APM) platform on Tuesday. The flaw impacts deployments configured as OAuth authorization servers and was already under active exploitation in the wild before the patch became available. BIG-IP APM is a software component in F5's BIG-IP hardware pl...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources:

<https://www.csoonline.com/article/4225721/f5-fixes-actively-exploited-zero-day-flaw-in-big-ip-apm.html>

07. Check Point warns of hackers exploiting Security Gateway VPN RCE flaw

Cybersecurity company Check Point has confirmed active exploitation of CVE-2026-85102, a pre-authentication remote code execution (RCE) vulnerability in the VPN certificate-handling functionality of its Security Gateway product. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/check-point-warns-of-hackers-exploiting-security-gateway-vpn-rce-flaw/>

08. The government must designate AI as critical infrastructure sooner rather than later

Here are five policy initiatives government and industry should act on before a catastrophic incident forces our hand.

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/perspective/the-government-must-designate-ai-as-critical-infrastructure-sooner-rather-than-later>

09. Hackers start exploiting critical WordPress flaw for code execution

Threat actors have moved from probing WordPress sites vulnerable to CVE-2026-87902 to exploiting the flaw to write files to disk that execute shell commands when accessed. [...]

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/hackers-start-exploiting-critical-wordpress-flaw-for-code-execution/>

10. VU#273940: Enterprise Access Management EAM does not rotate RSA keys

Overview Imprivata Enterprise Access Management (EAM), an authentication and single sign-on platform for enterprise and clinical environments, contains a vulnerability in versions 26.2.6 and below. The product provides no supported mechanism to rotate its

RSA key pair after deployment, meaning the same key pair is used indefinitely to generate the appliance...

Why it matters: Exploit-ready vulnerabilities can rapidly translate into compromise-especially for internet-facing services and widely deployed products.

Recommendation: Prioritize patching/mitigations, review exposure, and add detection for exploitation attempts (e.g., WAF/EDR signatures and logs).

Sources: <https://kb.cert.org/vuls/id/273940>

Data Breach & Cybercrime (10)

01. Ransomware group PAYLOAD weaponizes Microsoft Active Directory for disruption

The PAYLOAD ransomware group targeted a manufacturing organization in the Middle East, gaining initial access via a compromised VPN account, Kaspersky reported.

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.scworld.com/brief/ransomware-group-payload-weaponizes-microsoft-active-directory-for-disruption>

02. How device code phishing gives scammers access to your account

A scammer asks you to enter a code to open a file or join a meeting. Approving it could sign them in to your account instead.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/how-to/2026/09/how-device-code-phishing-gives-scammers-access-to-your-account>

03. GitHub App keys can still enable takeovers long after they are forgotten

GitHub allows organizations to install GitHub Apps that automate and extend certain functionality on the platform and have access to selected repositories and permissions. But the private keys these applications use to authenticate themselves can remain valid for years unless manually revoked. If leaked, those keys can potentially give attackers administrative access...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.csoonline.com/article/4225633/github-app-keys-can-still-enable-takeovers-long-after-they-are-forgotten-2.html>

04. Hundreds of Leaked GitHub App Keys Still Authenticate

GitGuardian finds 474 leaked GitHub App keys still authenticating, including keys with admin access

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/hundreds-leaked-github-app-keys/>

05. Network Solutions Dark Web Monitoring alerts small businesses to domain-linked data exposure

Network Solutions has launched Dark Web Monitoring, a new security capability that alerts small businesses when information associated with their domain appears in known breach data and provides steps they can take to reduce risk. Stolen credentials and other information exposed in data breaches can circulate across dark web marketplaces, forums and other s...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.helpnetsecurity.com/2026/09/23/network-solutions-dark-web-monitoring/>

06. ShinyHunters claims FBI breach was revenge for “false” report

The extortion group says it stole sensitive data on FBI agents and job applicants, and wants the bureau to retract a warning about its tactics.

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.malwarebytes.com/blog/news/2026/09/shinyhunters-claims-fbi-breach-was-revenge-for-false-report>

07. Ransomware Attacks Reach Record High for 2026

A total of 1073 firms fell victim to ransomware attacks globally in August, with the industrial sector the most affected, according to new NCC data

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.infosecurity-magazine.com/news/ransomware-attacks-reach-record/>

08. AI-Powered Phishing Platform EvilTokens Disrupted by Microsoft

The cybercrime platform leveraged AI at every step of the attack chain, including writing social engineering messages and deciding targets. The post AI-Powered Phishing Platform EvilTokens Disrupted by Microsoft appeared first on SecurityWeek .

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://www.securityweek.com/ai-powered-phishing-platform-eviltokens-disrupted-by-microsoft/>

09. [+24h Old] Ryuk ransomware member sentenced to 24 months in prison

An Armenian man was sentenced to 24 months in prison and 3 years of supervised release for hacking U.S. companies and encrypting their systems in Ryuk ransomware attacks. [...]

Why it matters: Ransomware operations combine disruption with extortion, making recovery speed and data-resilience core business risks.

Recommendation: Verify offline backups, test restores, harden remote access, and review segmentation to limit lateral movement.

Sources: <https://www.bleepingcomputer.com/news/security/ryuk-ransomware-member-sentenced-to-24-months-in-prison/>

10. [+24h Old] ShinyHunters Claims FBI Breach, Says It Stole Data on Agents and Job Applicants

The cyber extortion group known as ShinyHunters on Tuesday claimed it had breached the U.S. Federal Bureau of Investigation and stolen data belonging to current and former employees at the agency. "We have compromised the FBI. We hold very sensitive data on almost ALL FBI Agents and individuals who filed an application with the FBI for a job," the group sai...

Why it matters: Breaches and cybercrime activity signal where attackers are focusing and what data types are actively monetized.

Recommendation: Validate incident-response readiness, monitor for exposed credentials, and reinforce MFA, phishing resistance, and data-loss controls.

Sources: <https://thehackernews.com/2026/09/shinyhunters-claims-fbi-breach-says-it.html>